

The 7-Day Self-Directed Living Starter Kit

Welcome to your personalized guide designed to empower you with tiny, achievable actions over the course of one week.

This plan is crafted to seamlessly integrate into your daily routine, helping you take control of your wellbeing and enhance your everyday life.

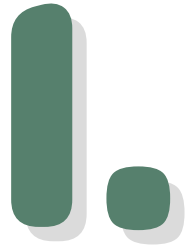
Get ready to embark on a transformative journey, one small step at a time.



This kit isn't about perfection.
It's about gentle progress.
Repeat, adapt, and grow at your own pace.

YOUR PATTERNS

Recognising your patterns is crucial for emotional intelligence, as it provides insight into habitual responses and behaviors. Understanding these patterns helps identify triggers for emotions, allowing for better management. This self-awareness promotes personal growth, conscious decision-making, and improved relationships, ultimately fostering a more positive and intentional life.



FOCUS: RECOGNISING YOUR PATTERNS

Breathe deeply, allowing yourself to connect with the harmony of your thoughts and actions throughout the day. As you go about your routine, nurture a sense of curiosity about any recurring habits or emotions.

Take five minutes to lovingly document your emotions from the day. Find a peaceful space where you can focus without distractions. As you write, explore the full range of your feelings. Consider what might have prompted these emotions and highlight anything significant to you.

WHAT ARE THE TRIGGERS THAT BRING ABOUT CERTAIN FEELINGS OR RESPONSES?

TRIGGER	RESPONSE

Identify one aspect that feels like a rain cloud, draining your energy, be it a habit, mindset, or relationship. Reflect on why this feels burdensome and gently envision ways you might transform it into an opportunity for growth.



Conversely, recognise one factor that uplifts your spirit, filling you with joy, motivation, or peace. This could be a small action, an inspiring conversation, or reaching a personal milestone. Acknowledging these positive influences will empower you to nurture and expand them.



Conclude your day by celebrating a small victory. Even if it seems minor, honour a positive deed or experience. Whether it involves completing a task, maintaining a positive outlook, or simply dedicating time to self-care, recognise this accomplishment as a meaningful step towards personal growth and enhanced self-awareness.



YOUR INTENTIONS

2.

Emotional intelligence is vital for setting intentions and achieving goals by managing emotions.

Understanding your emotional state allows you to choose intention-setting words that align with your needs and aspirations, fostering purpose and direction. For example, recognising stress can help you select calming activities to enhance focus and well-being. Integrating emotional intelligence into intention-setting creates a more meaningful and effective path to reaching goals.



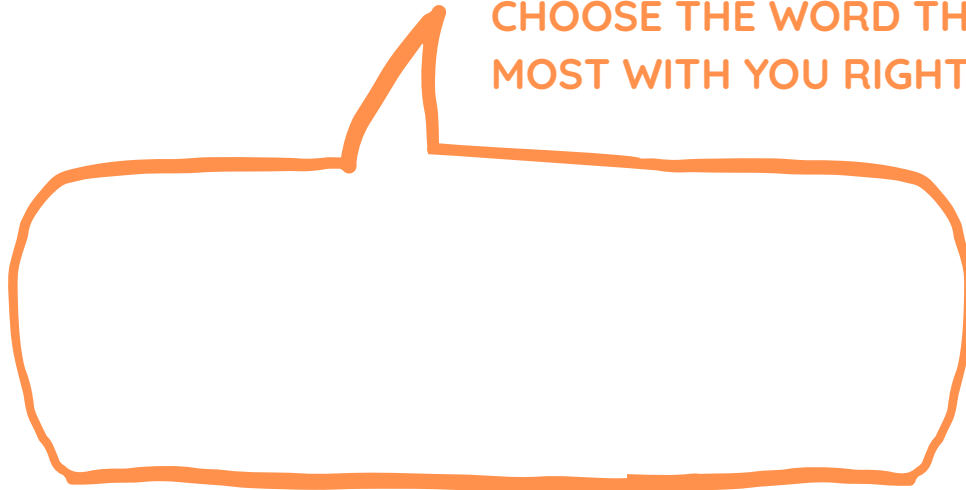
KNOW
YOUR
GOAL

FOCUS: SETTING YOUR INTENTIONS

CHOOSE YOUR WORD

Start by thinking about how you want to feel this week. Maybe you want to feel "calm" amidst a busy schedule, "focused" to tackle a big project, or "free" to enjoy life's little moments.

TAKE A MOMENT TO REFLECT AND
CHOOSE THE WORD THAT RESONATES
MOST WITH YOU RIGHT NOW.



MAKE IT VISIBLE:



Once you've picked your word, write it down. You could jot it on a sticky note and place it on your bathroom mirror, write it in your planner, or even set it as your phone's wallpaper. The key is to put it somewhere you'll see often, so it serves as a constant reminder throughout your week.

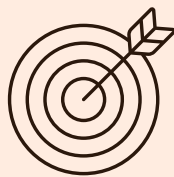


ALIGN WITH ACTION

Now, think of one simple action you can do that aligns with your chosen word. Whatever it is, ensure it's something achievable and meaningful to you.

**CALM**

Maybe you could start your mornings with a few minutes of quiet without distraction.

**FOCUSED**

Perhaps you could set aside time to create a to-do list each day.

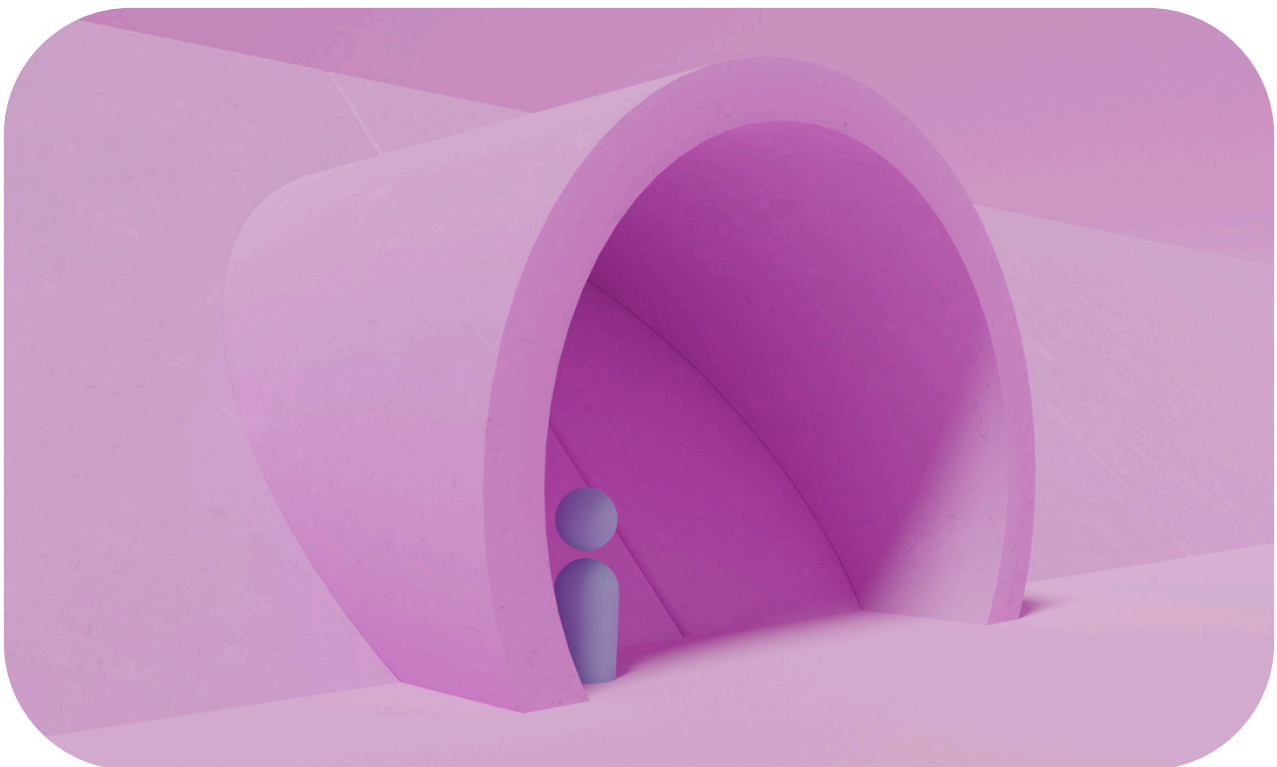
**FREE**

For this you might decide to take a walk outside every afternoon.

YOUR BOUNDARIES

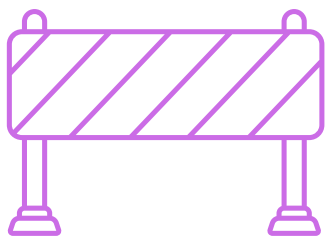
3.

Emotional intelligence involves understanding and managing your emotions while recognizing others' feelings. Key aspects include setting boundaries and prioritizing self-care, which demonstrate self-awareness and self-regulation. Engaging in tasks that align with your values protects emotional health, while breaks from screens aid stress management. Reflecting on these practices boosts self-awareness, leading to better decision-making and healthier relationships, ultimately fostering a more fulfilling life.



FOCUS: PROTECT YOUR ENERGY

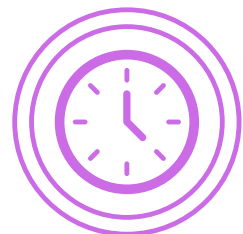
Sometimes, it's important to set boundaries and put yourself first. One way to do this is by saying "no" to something that doesn't benefit or serve you. By choosing to say "no," you're prioritising your own well-being and creating space for things that truly matter to you.



IT COULD BE A TASK, AN OBLIGATION,
OR EVEN A RELATIONSHIP THAT
DRAINS YOUR ENERGY.

Next, take a 10-minute break from screens. Whether it's your phone, computer, or television, stepping away from technology can be refreshing. This break helps to recharge your mind and gives your eyes a chance to rest.

USE THIS TIME TO GO FOR A SHORT
WALK, DO SOME LIGHT STRETCHING,
OR SIMPLY SIT QUIETLY AND ENJOY
THE MOMENT.



FOCUS: PROTECT YOUR ENERGY

After your break, spend a few moments reflecting on how it feels to give yourself permission to pause.



NOTICE ANY CHANGES IN YOUR MOOD, ENERGY LEVELS, OR MINDSET.

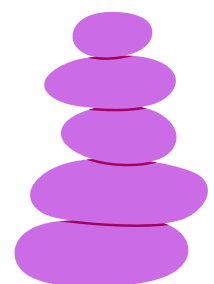
Acknowledge the benefits of taking a step back and appreciate the positive impact it can have on your day.

NOTICE ANY ASPECT THAT WAS POSITIVE, EITHER DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY



By allowing yourself these moments of rest and reflection, you're empowering yourself to lead a more balanced and fulfilling life.

**Find
Balance**



YOUR CONNECTIONS

4.

This exercise enhances emotional intelligence through self-awareness, empathy, and interpersonal skills. It starts with expressing gratitude to someone important, promoting emotional expression. Next, it emphasises active listening and empathy to foster genuine connections. Finally, reflecting on these interactions deepens self-awareness and encourages meaningful relationships, essential for personal growth.



FOCUS: REACH OUT

Take a moment to think about someone in your life who you truly appreciate. It could be a friend, family member, mentor, or even a colleague.

**WHO IS SOMEONE IN YOUR LIFE THAT YOU WOULD
FEEL SAFE EXPRESSING YOUR FEELINGS TO?**

Once you've got that person in mind, send them a heartfelt message. It doesn't have to be lengthy; just a few sincere words expressing your gratitude or appreciation for having them in your life can make all the difference.

1. Acknowledge their energy in your journey, and let them know how much they mean to you. Reaching out with genuine words can strengthen your bond and bring joy to both you and the person you're grateful for.

INSPIRING

COMPASSIONATE

GRACIOUS

SUPPORTIVE

DETERMINED

ENCOURAGING

AUTHENTIC

BOLD

UPLIFTING

FUN

Spend at least five minutes engaging in a genuine conversation or connection with them. This could be through a phone call, a video chat, or even a face-to-face meeting if possible. Focus on really listening to them and sharing your thoughts too. The aim is to create a moment of authentic connection where both parties feel valued and heard.

**THINGS I WANT
TO SAY**

**THINGS I WANT TO
HEAR ABOUT**



After your conversation, take a few minutes to reflect on how this connection has affected your mood. Notice any changes in how you feel. Consider whether you feel more uplifted, motivated, or content. Recognising these shifts can empower you to seek meaningful connections more often, enhancing your well-being and strengthening your relationships.

**HOW I FELT DURING
THE CONVERSATION**

**HOW I FEEL
AFTERWARDS**



YOUR MOVEMENT

5.

Engaging in movement boosts emotional intelligence by increasing body awareness and fostering self-regulation. Physical activity releases endorphins, reducing stress and enhancing emotional balance. Reflecting on moods after exercise improves emotional insight, while celebrating achievements fosters positivity. Understanding emotional needs through movement enhances empathy and interpersonal interactions, benefiting both physical health and emotional well-being.



FOCUS: SHIFT YOUR STATE

CHOOSE YOUR MOVEMENT

Decide on a form of movement that you enjoy. This could be a gentle walk around your neighbourhood, a series of stretches in your living room, or even a little dance to your favourite song. The key is to pick something that feels good to you.



WHAT ACTIVITY MAKES YOU FEEL POSITIVE?

SET A TIMER

Commit to moving for at least 10 minutes. Setting a timer can help you stay focused and ensure you give yourself the full time to experience the benefits.

IF IT FEELS OVERWHELMING
AT FIRST, TRY 2 LOTS OF FIVE
MINS DURING THE DAY, OR 10
LOTS OF 60 SECONDS.



FOCUS: SHIFT YOUR STATE

GET MOVING

Start your chosen activity and immerse yourself in the movement. Feel the rhythm of your steps, the stretch of your muscles, or the sway of your hips as you dance. Let yourself enjoy the moment.

DID YOU CHOOSE ANY BACKGROUND MUSIC?
MAYBE THE RADIO STATION YOU PREFER?
WHAT SONG WOULD YOU CHOOSE NEXT TIME?



REFLECT AFTERWARDS

Once your 10 minutes are up, pause and notice how your body feels now. Acknowledge these shifts, however small they may be.



HAS ANYTHING CHANGED?
DO YOU FEEL MORE ENERGISED OR RELAXED?

FOCUS: SHIFT YOUR STATE

CELEBRATE YOUR EFFORT

Finally, take a moment to celebrate the fact that you showed up for yourself today. It's not about how hard or fast you moved, but the fact that you took the time to care for your wellbeing.



I AM PROUD OF MYSELF BEACUSE



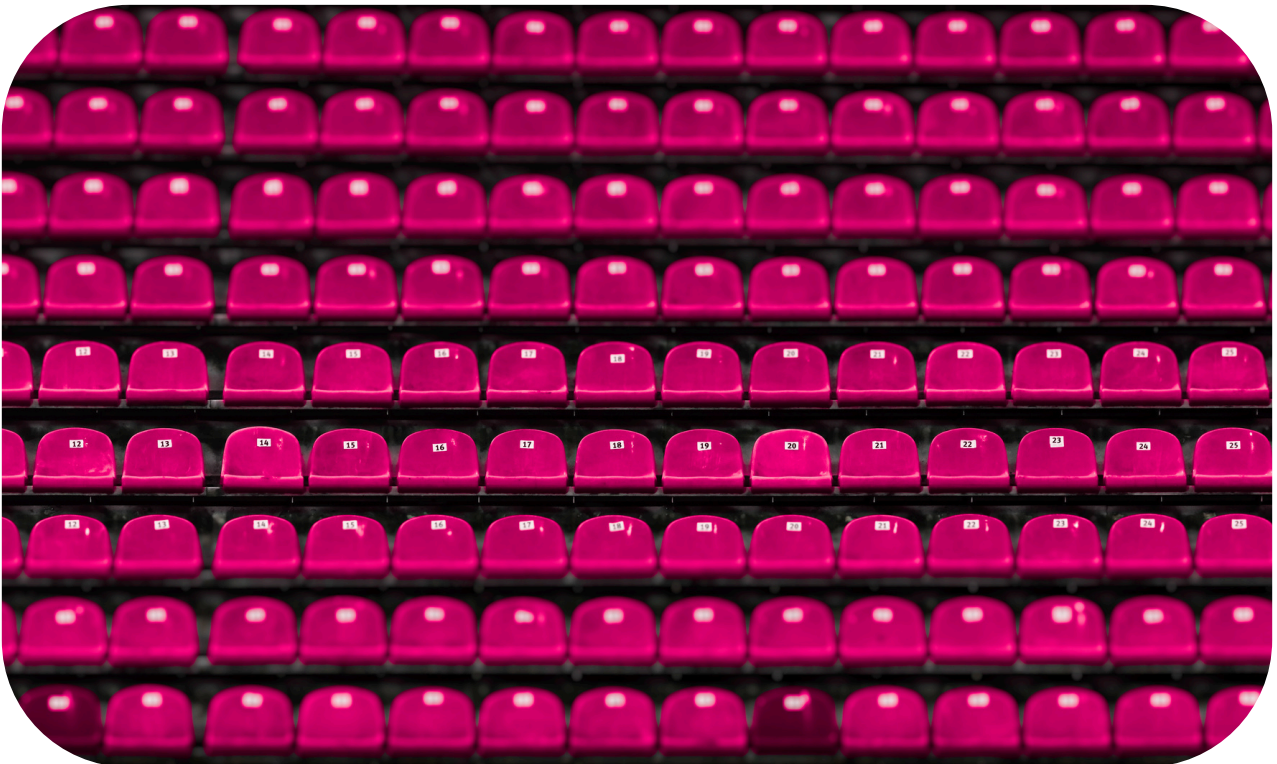
WRITE A NOTE TO YOURSELF, WRITE A LIST OF REASONS TO DO THIS AGAIN OR EVEN JUST ADD A PHOTO OF YOU SMILING AND ENJOYING YOURSELF DURING THE EXERCISE. THIS IS FOR YOU.



YOUR GRATITUDE

6.

Practicing gratitude enhances emotional intelligence by improving self-awareness and emotional regulation. It helps individuals recognise positive aspects of life, which strengthens their emotional awareness and interactions. Sharing gratitude builds trust, empathy, and supportive relationships. Additionally, it fosters optimism and resilience, promoting overall emotional well-being. Ultimately, gratitude cultivates self-awareness, emotional management, and stronger social connections for a more fulfilling life.



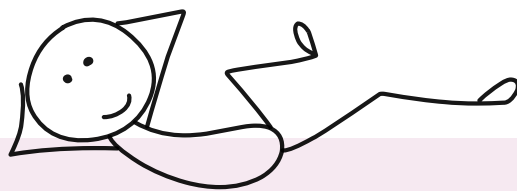
FOCUS: REFRAME YOUR PERSPECTIVE.

Begin by listing three things you are grateful for today. It might be the warm sunshine that brightened your morning, the comforting aroma of your favourite tea, or a kind gesture from a friend. Spend a moment reflecting on each item and appreciate the positivity they bring into your life.

**TODAY I
ENJOYED...**

**TODAY, I FELT
GOOD WHEN...**

**TODAY, I SMILED
BEACUSE...**



**YOU CAN ALSO WRITE THREE OF YOUR
OWN SENTENCES TOO.**

1
2
3

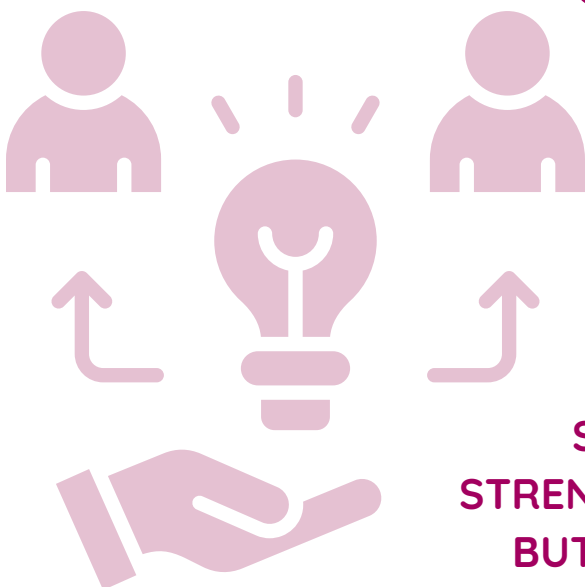
FOCUS: REFRAME YOUR PERSPECTIVE.

Next, choose one of these things to share with someone else. Perhaps you could tell a friend how much you appreciate their support, or express gratitude to a colleague for their help on a project.

I WILL TALK TO:

WHEN:

I WANT TO SAY:



**SHARING GRATITUDE NOT ONLY
STRENGTHENS YOUR RELATIONSHIPS
BUT ALSO SPREADS HAPPINESS TO
THOSE AROUND YOU.**



YOUR REFLECTION

7.

This practice emphasizes emotional intelligence through self-reflection and awareness. By reviewing notes and achievements, individuals improve their emotional understanding and progress. It promotes self-regulation by identifying helpful habits for organization and motivation, while recognizing accomplishments enhances self-compassion and emotional well-being, fostering a positive self-relationship.



FOCUS: LOOK BACK AND LOOK FORWARD



Begin by taking some time to review your notes from the week.

Go through each point carefully and reflect on what you have achieved.



Next, identify one habit or mindset that you found particularly beneficial and that you would like to carry forward into the future.

THIS COULD BE SOMETHING THAT HELPED YOU STAY ORGANISED, MOTIVATED, OR POSITIVE.

- **I WOULD TRY THIS ACTIVITY AGAIN:**

FOCUS: LOOK BACK AND LOOK FORWARD

Finally, conclude the week by finding a quiet moment to reflect on your accomplishments. Allow yourself to feel a sense of pride in all that you have achieved. Remember, you showed up for yourself, and that is something truly worth celebrating.

LET'S
- CELEBRATE -
you

THIS WEEK I HAVE STEPPED
OUT OF MY COMFORT ZONE
AND ACHIVED: